Lengcheng Shim Traditional Architecture & Roof-Horns

Resource Identifier: CULT-TRAD-006

English Translation: Traditional High-Status House Architecture with Crossed Roof-Horns

Category: Tradition | Subcategory: Architecture

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Master Woodcarvers & Awunga Builders (Documented in Horam 1977, Ruivah 1993)

License: Traditional Cultural Expression (Permissions: community_authorized)

Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Dry construction season

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Elite Tangkhul house architecture featuring crossed carved wooden horns (Lengcheng Kui) extending from the roof ridge, with facade planks intricately carved with mithun heads and solar symbols.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Lengcheng Shimli Lengcheng Kui kachui, Tangkhul ngashan thotna."
"Thing kaphungli mithun kazei, mikon kachivali masot pamei."
"Maran Kasa mibingna kashak, iram kaphungli ningyang kaung."

English Translation & Meaning:

"The Lengcheng Shim proudly bears the crossed roof-horns, the architectural crown of Tangkhul heritage."
"Carved facade planks depicting mithun heads, hornbills, and celestial solar discs."
"Erected by those who accomplished the Feast of Merit, a testament to community beneficence."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Harvesting durable hardwood timber and broad planks from communal mountain forests.
2. Hand-hewing facade planks with intricate relief carvings of hornbills, mithun, and rosettes.
3. Constructing broad thatched roof crowned with extended crossed wooden horns (Lengcheng Kui).
4. Communal house-raising (Shim kashak) supported by all village clans.
5. Consecration feast accompanied by prayers for family prosperity and village peace.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Master Woodcarvers, Awunga & Nobility, Community Building Teams

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